Conversation track 1, 3, 4

Aaron is moving out tomorrow. His friend Bella comes over to help him pack.

Bella: Wow, you look exhausted! What **have** you **been doing**?

Aaron: **I've been packing** since six. My back is killing me.

Bella: Yikes. So how many boxes have you done?

Aaron: Only twelve, believe it or not. **I've been going through** old stuff all day.

Bella: Oh, that's always the slowest part. Find anything good?

Aaron: Tons of old photos. **I've been laughing** at my high school haircut for an hour.

Bella: Ha! I need to see that. But first, where's the tape?

Aaron: Under that pile of shirts, I think. Thanks for coming, seriously.

Study Notes

My back is killing me.
Lưng mình đau chết đi được.
"… is killing me" là cách nói phóng đại khi một chỗ trên cơ thể rất đau: My feet are killing me.
Cách nói tương đương: My back really hurts.

Only twelve, believe it or not.
Mới có mười hai thùng, nói ra chắc bạn không tin.
"believe it or not" chèn vào khi kể điều đáng ngạc nhiên, đặt đầu hoặc cuối câu đều được.
Cách nói tương đương: Would you believe it? Only twelve.

Speak Like a Native track 2

1. What have you been doing?
change: "What have" (t → d nhẹ)
weak: "have", "you", "been"
strong: "doing"
"What have" nối thành "wa-đơv": âm /h/ của "have" mất, /t/ đọc như "d" nhẹ. Cả câu nghe như "wa-đơv-yơ-bin-đu-ing", nhấn vào "doing".

2. I've been going through old stuff all day.
change: "old stuff" (mất âm d)
linking: "stuff‿all‿day"
strong: "going through", "all day"
Âm /d/ của "old" kẹp giữa hai phụ âm nên bị nuốt: "ôl-stớf". "stuff all day" nối liền: "stớ-fol-đây". "I've been" lướt nhanh, nhẹ: "aiv-bin".

3. I've been laughing at my high school haircut for an hour.
linking: "laughing‿at", "for‿an‿hour"
strong: "high", "haircut"
"laughing at" nối thành "le-phin-gơt". Danh từ ghép nhấn âm đầu: HIGH school, HAIRcut. "for an hour" nối liền, chữ "h" câm: "fơ-rơ-nao-ơr".

• "been" trong giọng Mỹ đọc ngắn, nhẹ /bɪn/ "bin", không kéo dài thành "biin".
• "have" sau từ để hỏi đọc nhẹ /əv/: What have you → "wa-đơv-yơ".
• Âm /d/, /t/ cuối từ hay bị nuốt trước phụ âm: old stuff → "ôl-stớf", need to → "ni-tơ".
• Nhấn vào hoạt động và thời gian: I've been PACKING since SIX.

Grammar Focus

Hiện tại hoàn thành tiếp diễn: have / has been + V-ing
Việc bắt đầu trong quá khứ, kéo dài đến bây giờ hoặc vừa dừng và còn để lại dấu vết. Hay đi với for, since, all day, How long…?

She's been learning Korean for two years.
The street is wet. **It's been raining**.
How long **have** you **been waiting**? – Not long.

have been + V-ing hay have + V3?
Nhấn vào quá trình, khoảng thời gian → have been + V-ing. Nhấn vào kết quả, số lượng đã làm xong → have + V3.

I've been writing emails all morning.
I've written fifteen emails so far.

Role Play track 6

A: Wow, you look exhausted! What have you been doing?

B: I've been _____ since six. My back is killing me.

A: Yikes. So how many boxes have you done?

B: Only twelve, believe it or not. I've been going through old stuff all day.

A: Oh, that's always the slowest part. Find anything good?

B: Tons of old photos. I've been laughing at my high school haircut _____.

A: Ha! I need to see that. But first, where's the tape?

B: Under that pile of shirts, I think. Thanks for _____, seriously.

Substitution Drill track 7

1. I've been packing since six.
   a. cleaning the kitchen
   b. carrying boxes
   c. wrapping dishes

2. I've been laughing at my high school haircut for an hour.
   a. since lunch
   b. all afternoon
   c. for twenty minutes

3. Thanks for coming, seriously.
   a. helping out
   b. bringing lunch
   c. giving up your Saturday